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# Collecting Data with iMotions Online

*This article describes best practices for data collection with iMotions Online.*

## Primary Factors for iMotions Online Data Quality

For iMotions Online, data quality primarily depends on the camera recording quality of the respondent's face.

- In general, videos should have a well-lit, in-focus view of the respondent's face and eyes at the center of the camera frame. It is also important to minimize other faces in the background of the recording (including photographs, people walking past, etc.) and avoid excess light directly upon the camera.
- For Webcam-based Eye Tracking, data quality additionally depends on eye tracker calibration quality. Respondents must maintain their gaze on the calibration points throughout the calibration process.
- For Webcam-based Eye Tracking, respondents should also avoid significant head movements away from their position during calibration, which adversely affects data quality. Additional calibration stimuli can be included, to augment eye-tracking data quality, which is recommended for every ~10 minutes of data collection.

The Visual options, available on the iMotions Online>Data Collection page, can be used to let respondents know if/when they have good lighting and positioning for data collection. Head position check is recommended and included by default, to ensure that respondents have sufficient lighting conditions and positioning at the start of participation. Eye detection will similarly ensure sufficient lighting and view of the respondent's eyes, which can improve eye tracking data quality.

## Visual options

The visual options allow you to define the number of checks made to ensure optimal data quality. Each of these options should be considered as part of a balance in ensuring optimal data quality, and brevity/ease for participants, which can have an impact on the number of participants who complete the study. Your precise study needs will determine the options you choose based on this tradeoff.

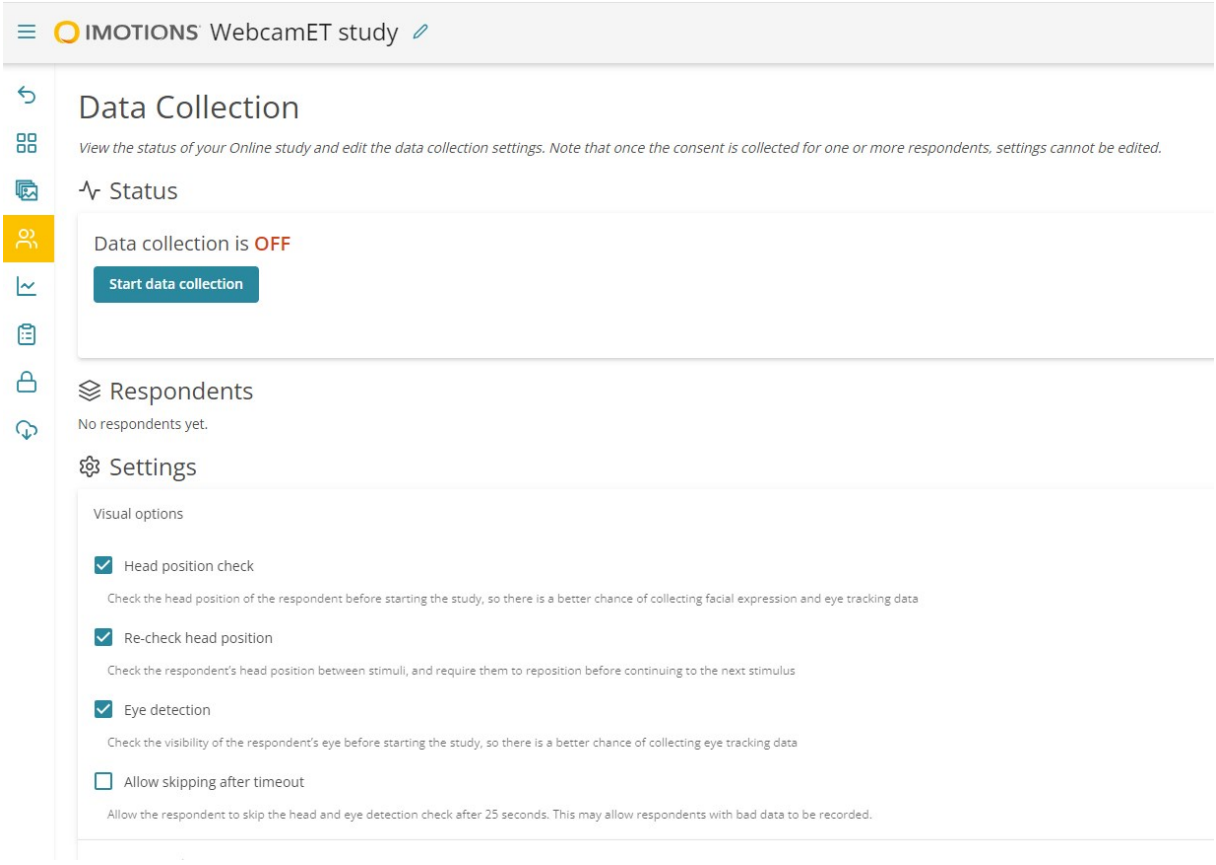
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Head position checks: If enabled, ensure that the participant's head is in the appropriate position (i.e. facing the screen) before starting the study. This check will only apply before the study starting.

Re-check head position: If enabled, check if the head position has been changed in between each stimulus exposure. This adds more time and complexity to the study but increases the likelihood of collecting optimal data. Only possible to enable if the head position check is enabled.

Eye detection: If enabled, check if the participant's eyes are visible before the study starts.

Allow skipping after timeout: If enabled, the participant can start the study after a detection check of 25 seconds without a successful detection of the head or eyes. Only possible to enable if the head position check or eye detection is enabled.




## Other Considerations

- Respondent computers will need to have an up-to-date internet browser that will allow camera and screen recordings. We recommend using the most recent versions of Chrome, Edge, or Firefox.
- Some internet browser add-ons/extensions/etc. may prevent participation in iMotions Online studies, e.g. privacy add-ons that prevent camera or

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screen recording. We recommend respondents use a browser without any additional add-ons/extensions.

- Respondent computers will also need sufficient hard drive space to temporarily store the video recordings (approximately 50 MB per minute of recording), as well as a stable/sufficient fast internet connection to upload these videos.

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